FILM TRACKER

Searching your library

What you can type, what each search token understands, and how to combine them into precise queries across a library of any size.

A QUERY BUILT FROM THREE TOKENS

⚲ Dir: kubrick Rating: 8+ !Genre: horror shining

Films directed by anyone matching “kubrick”, rated 8 or higher, not in a genre matching “horror”, with “shining” in the title.

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CHAPTER 1

The basics

There are two kinds of search: plain text, and tokens. Plain text is the quick way to find a title. Tokens are how you ask precise questions about any other part of a film.

Opening the search field

The search field is in the window's toolbar and always searches the **entire film library**, regardless of which sidebar item you were looking at. Press `⌘F` (View > Search Film Library) to jump straight into it from anywhere. When you clear the search, you return to the view you started from.

The search results have their own sort, filters, and grid or list style, which start fresh with every search. They stay in effect for as long as the search field holds anything, including a pill with no text beside it. To start over completely, empty the field, pills included.

Plain-text search

Type any text; results update as you type. Plain text matches against a film's **title and its alternate titles**. Matching is not case-sensitive, and the text can appear anywhere inside the title, not only at the start. Accents and punctuation are ignored, and every kind of dash counts as the same character, so you can type titles the way your keyboard writes them.

YOU TYPE	FINDS
`matrix`	The Matrix, The Matrix Reloaded, and any film with "matrix" in an alternate title
`ton`	Anything containing those letters anywhere: "Clinton", "Tonight", "Button"
`THE GODFATHER`	Same as lowercase; capitalization never matters
`mission impossible fallout`	Mission: Impossible – Fallout; the colon and the dash are ignored
`amelie`	Amélie; accents never matter
`spiderman`	Spider-Man; punctuation inside a word is ignored, so "spider-man" finds it too

Suggestions and recent searches

As you type, a menu below the field suggests values from your library: titles for plain text, and, once you type the space after a field name, that field's values (people for `#cast`, tags for `#tag`, list names for `#list`, and so on). Picking a suggestion adds it exactly as shown. The closest matches to what you type always come first. Among similar matches, suggestions rise when you search for them often, when they relate to the pills already in the field or to your recent searches (after `#director nolan`, `#cast` lists his regular cast first), and when they belong to films you rate highly, watch often, watched or added recently, have queued or ranked in the Hall of Fame, or have a release coming soon. Values you have searched for before are suggested even when they are not library text, such as a year range. You can also type initials (`tdk` for The Dark Knight) or words in any order (`hanks tom`). Clicking the empty field lists your ten most recent searches from this session; pick one to run it again. The menu shows at most 30 rows.

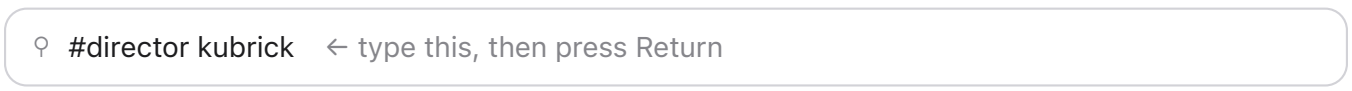
Both are on by default and can be turned off in Settings > General. Recent searches are kept only until you quit Film Tracker. What the suggestions have learned is kept on this Mac, and it fades over time when you stop using it.

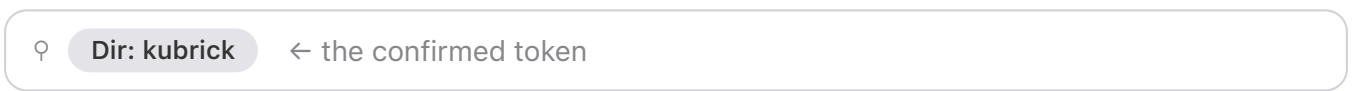
Tokens: asking about something other than the title

A token pairs a **field** (such as Director or Rating) with a **value** (such as "kubrick" or "8+"). Tokens appear in the search field as small rounded pills, like the ones on the cover.

Creating a token

1. **Type `#`.** The search field switches into token entry and a list of every field appears below it. While you are entering a token, the results hold still; they update once the token is confirmed.
2. **Type the field name**, or pick it from the list. You can type any name or shortcut from Chapter 3 (`#director`, `#dir`, `#rating`, `#lastwatched`) or the full display name with spaces (`#last watched`, `#executive producer`). The list narrows as you type.
3. **Press Space, then type the value.** Everything after the field name, spaces included, is the value: `#cast tom hanks` searches for "tom hanks".
4. **Press Return.** The token becomes a pill and the results update. Nothing happens if there is no value yet, so a bare `#director` followed by Return does not create a token.





> **TIP**
> You can keep typing plain text after a token is made, and you can add as many tokens as you like. Typed text always narrows by title, on top of whatever the tokens do.

Shortcuts into search from the sidebar

In a film's Details tab, the Studio, Cast, Director, Producer, Executive Producer, Screenwriter, and Composer sections each show a small magnifying-glass button beside every name. Clicking one performs that search immediately, creating the token for you.

Removing a token

Delete the pill the same way you would delete any token in a macOS search field: select it and press Delete, or place the cursor after it and press Delete once. The results update immediately.

What the pill shows

Pills use short labels so they stay compact, and a list name longer than 20 characters is shortened with "…". Two optional prefixes mark how a token behaves (Chapter 2). The long field names are abbreviated as follows:

FIELD	PILL LABEL
Director	Dir
Producer	Pro
Executive Producer	ExPro
Screenwriter	ScWtr
Composer	Comp
Duration	Dur
Last Watched	LstWch
Rotation Threshold	RoThr
Everything else	The full field name, such as Rating or Date Added

HOW MATCHING WORKS

Unless a chapter says otherwise, a text value matches when it appears *anywhere* inside the stored text, ignoring capitalization, accents, and punctuation. Runs of spaces count as one space. `#director nolan` finds “Christopher Nolan”; `#genre sci` finds “Sci-Fi”. You never need wildcards, and you never need quotation marks around multi-word values.

ONE CHARACTER TO AVOID

Do not use `#` inside a value (for example in a note you are looking for). The last `#` in the field always starts a new token.

CHAPTER 2

Combining tokens

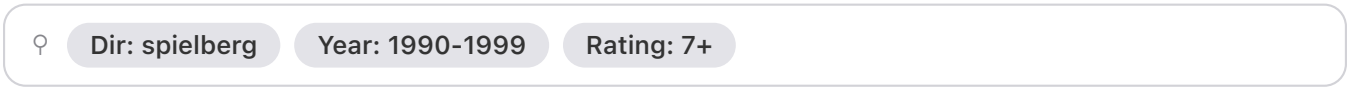
Every token can be given one of three behaviors by a prefix typed straight after the `#`: the default AND, an OR with `/`, or a NOT with `!`.

YOU TYPE	PILL	MEANING
`#director kubrick`	Dir: kubrick	**AND.** The film must match this token. With several AND tokens, a film must match all of them.
`#/director kubrick`	/Dir: kubrick	**OR.** Films matching this token are added to the results, whether or not they match the other tokens.
`#!genre horror`	!Genre: horror	**NOT.** Films matching this token are removed from the results.
`#/!genre horror`	/!Genre: horror	OR and NOT together. The slash comes first. This behaves exactly like NOT: it removes matches.

Typing the prefix is the only difference. After `#` you can type `/`, `!`, or `/!`, and the field list shows a green “Or” or a red “Not” beside each field to confirm the mode.

AND: narrowing down

Each additional AND token trims the results further. This is the most common way to search.



Result: Spielberg films released in the 1990s *and* rated 7 or higher.

Two tokens of the *same* field are also ANDed. `#cast tom hanks` plus `#cast meg ryan` returns only films listing both actors.

OR: widening

An OR token contributes its own matches to the results. To find films by either of two directors, make both tokens OR:



Result: every Kubrick film plus every Scorsese film.

OR IS NOT PARENTHESIZED

OR tokens are checked against the *whole library*, not against what the AND tokens have already narrowed to. The results are: **(all AND tokens together) plus (anything matching any OR token)**. So `Rating: 8+` with `/Dir: kubrick` returns every film rated 8+ *and* every Kubrick film, rated or not. It does not mean "Kubrick films rated 8+" (use two plain AND tokens for that).

It follows that you cannot express "(A or B) and C" in one search. When you need that, run the OR search first and sort or scan the result, or find a field that covers both A and B (the Crew token, for example, covers every credited person at once).

NOT: excluding

A NOT token removes its matches from everything that survives the positive tokens. Because it is applied last among the tokens, it also removes films that an OR token brought in.



Result: A24 films that are not horror.

A NOT token on its own is also fine: `#!genre documentary` returns every film that is not a documentary.

The order of operations

1. All AND tokens narrow the library to the films matching every one of them.
2. All OR tokens are matched against the whole library and their matches are added in.
3. If there are only OR tokens, the OR matches are the whole result; if there are only AND tokens, the AND matches are.
4. All NOT tokens remove their matches.
5. Any plain text you typed narrows what is left by title.

READING A NOT AS "THE OPPOSITE"

A NOT token returns every film the plain token would *not* have returned. That makes it exact for questions of the form "everything except", and it also means that a value the app cannot interpret (a misspelled keyword, say) turns into *every film* when negated, because the plain version matched nothing. See Chapter 10.

CHAPTER 3

Field names and shortcuts

Every token answers to several names. All are accepted in either case, and all work after `#`, `#/`, `#!`, and `#/!`. The field list also matches the beginning of any name, so typing `#exe` narrows the list to Executive Producer.

FIELD	ACCEPTED NAMES	KIND OF VALUE	CHAPTER
Title	`title` `name`	Text	4
Crew	`crew` `crewman` `crewmen` `people` `person`	Text, any credited person	4
Cast	`cast` `actor` `actors` `actress`	Text	4
Director	`director` `directors` `dir`	Text	4
Producer	`producer` `producers` `prod`	Text	4
Executive Producer	`executiveproducer` `executiveproducers` `execproducer` `exprod` `exp`	Text	4
Screenwriter	`screenwriter` `screenwriters` `scrwr` `writer` `writers`	Text	4
Composer	`composer` `composers` `comp` `music`	Text	4
Genre	`genre` `genres`	Text	4
Studio	`studio` `company` `group`	Text	4
Tags	`tag` `tags`	Text	4
Notes	`note` `notes`	Text	4
Synopsis	`synopsis` `plot` `description`	Words, any order	4
List	`list` `lists`	Text, list name	4
Is	`is` `flag` `flags`	Keywords, comma-separated	4
Year	`year` `years` `releaseyear` `date`	Number or range	5

Duration	`duration` `runtime` `length` `time`	Minutes	5
Rating	`rating` `userrating` `rate` `score`	0 to 10	5
Last Watched	`lastwatched` `lastviewed` `watched` `viewed` `lv`	Date	6
Date Added	`dateadded` `added` `imported`	Date	6
Release	`release` `releases` `rel`	Keywords	7
Rotation Threshold	`rotationthreshold` `rotation` `threshold` `roth`	Months, years, or keyword	8

TWO-WORD FIELD NAMES: A TRAP

The app reads the field name left to right and stops at the *first* word that is a field name by itself. That is harmless for most names (`#last watched 2023` , `#executive producer spielberg` , and `#user rating 8+` all work), but two fields contain a word that is a complete field name of its own:

- `#date added 2024` is read as **Year** (`date`) with the value “added 2024”.
- `#rotation threshold 24` is read as **Rotation Threshold** with the value “threshold 24”, which matches nothing.

Type these as one word (`#dateadded` , `#rotationthreshold`), use a shortcut (`#added` , `#rotation`), or pick the field from the suggestion list, which always inserts the correct form.

EASY TO MIX UP

`#date` means the film’s **release year**, not the date you added or watched a film, and not the date of one of its disc releases (that is `#release 2027` ; Chapter 7). For those use `#added` and `#watched` . Likewise `#studio` is the studio credited on the film itself, while the studio or distributor of an individual disc is searched through `#release` (Chapter 7).

CHAPTER 4

Text tokens

These tokens match words. The value may be any part of the text you are looking for, in any capitalization, and may contain spaces.

Title

`#title` behaves exactly like plain text typed in the field: it checks the title and any alternate titles. Its use is for combining with NOT or OR, for example `#!title star` to hide every film with “star” in its title.

People

TOKEN	SEARCHES
`#cast`	The cast list
`#director`	Directors
`#producer`	Producers
`#executiveproducer`	Executive producers
`#screenwriter`	Screenwriters
`#composer`	Composers
`#crew`	All six of the above at once: a film matches if the name appears in *any* of them

QUERY	FINDS
`#director nolan`	Films with a director whose name contains “nolan”
`#cast tom hanks`	Films with Tom Hanks in the cast
`#crew spielberg`	Films where Spielberg appears as a director, producer, executive producer, writer, composer, or cast member
`#composer williams`	Films scored by anyone named Williams
`#director coppola` `#!director sofia`	Coppola films, minus the ones whose director list also matches “sofia”

TIP

Searching a surname alone is the safest way to find someone, since spelling of first names and middle initials varies. Use the full name when a surname is common, because the match is on the letters, not on whole words.

Genre, Studio, Tags

- `#genre` matches the film’s genre text. `#genre sci` finds Sci-Fi; `#genre drama` finds Drama and Crime Drama.
- `#studio` matches the studio or studios credited on the film itself.
- `#tags` matches any of the film’s tags. A film matches if *any one* of its tags contains the text.

Notes

`#notes` searches both of the free-text areas a film carries: your own notes and the film’s description notes. A match in either one counts. It does *not* look at the film’s plot summary; that is what `#synopsis` is for.

Synopsis

`#synopsis` (also `#plot` and `#description`) searches the film’s plot summary. It behaves differently from the other text tokens: it looks for **every word you type, in any order**, rather than for the exact text you typed.

QUERY	FINDS
`#synopsis detective sins mills`	Seven (1995): its summary mentions a detective, Mills, and the seven deadly sins, though not in that order
`#plot heist vault`	Any film whose summary contains both “heist” and “vault”
`#description vampire`	A single word works too
`#!synopsis alien`	Every film whose summary does not mention “alien”

- **Every word must be present.** Adding a word only ever narrows the results, so if a search finds nothing, drop the least certain word.
- **Words, not phrases.** `#synopsis serial killer` finds summaries containing “serial” and “killer” anywhere, not necessarily next to each other.
- **Each word matches inside longer words**, like every text token: `murder` finds “murders” and “murderer”, but `murders` does not find “murder”. Type the shortest stem that is still distinctive.
- **Leave punctuation out.** Type `detective`, not `detective,`; a comma becomes part of the word being looked for.

List

`#list` finds films that belong to the list you name. Once you type the space after `#list`, the suggestion list shows every list you can search, narrowing as you type; pick one to add it as a pill. It searches your own lists, the built-in smart lists (as long as smart lists are enabled in Settings), and the two ranked lists in Reports: **Hall of Fame** and **Release Wishlist** (a film is on the wishlist when at least one of its releases is wishlisted), and the five Recents tabs. The internal Film Queue lists are not searchable this way.

A Recents tab matches exactly the films that tab shows, up to its 200 most recent. In suggestions these are marked “Recents:”.

Most Recently Viewed	also `most recently watched`, `recently watched`, `recently viewed`
Recently Come Up for Rotation	also `recently up for rotation`
Recently Added	

Recently Updated
Recently Purchased

The built-in smart list names are:

Up for Rotation	Viewed Over One Year Ago	Purchased
Purchased 4K	Purchased Blu-ray	Purchased DVD
Unpurchased	Unpurchased 4K	Unpurchased Blu-ray
Unpurchased DVD	Edited	Alternate Versions
Filtered Library	Waiting for Edit	Temporarily On Hold
Indefinitely On Hold	Ignore	Blacklisted
Upcoming Releases	No Releases Added	

SUBSTRINGS CAN OVERLAP

When your text is a list's full name (in any case), only that list matches, even if the name appears inside another one: `#list purchased 4k` is the Purchased 4K list alone, not Unpurchased 4K as well. Text that is not a full list name matches every list whose name contains it, so `#list 4k` covers both Purchased 4K and Unpurchased 4K.

QUERY	FINDS
`#list favorites`	Films on the list named "Favorites", or, if no list has that exact name, on any list whose name contains it
`#list up for rotation`	Films currently in the Up for Rotation smart list
`#list purchased 4k`	Films in the Purchased 4K smart list
`#list hall of fame`	Films ranked in the Hall of Fame
`#list wishlist`	Films with a release on the Release Wishlist
`#list most recently watched`	The films on the Most Recently Viewed tab
`#list recently`	Every Recents tab at once, since each name contains "recently"

Is

`#is` tests yes/no properties of a film, several at once. Separate the terms with commas; a film must satisfy every one. Put `!` (or `not`) in front of a single term to require the opposite. One `#is` pill can therefore replace several `#list` pills.

Once you type the space after `#is`, the suggestion list offers the terms. Picking one completes the term you are typing and leaves the token open, so you can type a comma and the next term; press **Return** to make the pill.

PROPERTY	TERMS	TRUE WHEN
Editing	`edited` `unedited`	The film is marked as edited
Viewing	`watched` `unwatched` (`seen` `viewed` `unseen` `unviewed` `never watched`)	The film is marked as watched
Rating	`rated` `unrated`	You have given the film a rating
Info	`complete` `incomplete` (`info complete` `info incomplete`)	The film's info is marked complete
Special sorting	`sorted` `unsorted` (`special sorting` `specially sorted` `no special sorting`)	The film carries any special sorting tag
One sorting tag	`waiting for edit` `waiting` `on hold` `held` `temporarily on hold` `temp on hold` `indefinitely on hold` `ignored` `ignore` `blacklisted`	The film carries that tag; `on hold` is either kind of hold
Ownership	`owned` `purchased` `owned 4k` `owned uhd` `purchased 4k` `owned blu-ray` `owned 2k` `purchased blu-ray` `owned dvd` `purchased dvd`	At least one purchased release (of that format)
Not owned	`unowned` `unpurchased` `no releases` `no releases added`	Releases, none purchased; or no releases at all
Releases	`wishlisted` `on wishlist` `wishlist` `upcoming`	A release on the Release Wishlist; a release still to come
Other	`alternate versions` `alt versions` `alternates` `hall of fame` `hof`	A purchased release with an alternate version; ranked in the Hall of Fame

NOT THE SAME AS THE SMART LISTS

Each term tests only the one property it names. The smart lists of similar names can add conditions of their own: **Filtered Library** also requires the film to be watched, and **Viewed Over One Year Ago** leaves out films with special sorting and waits until the 1st of the month after the anniversary. `unsorted` is only "no special sorting". A term the app does not recognize makes the whole pill match nothing, so a typo shows up as an empty result rather than a wider one.

!TERM INSIDE VERSUS #!IS

`#is owned 4k, !edited` means "owned in 4K and not edited". `#!is owned 4k, edited` removes the films that are *both* owned in 4K and edited, which keeps every film missing either one.

QUERY	FINDS
`#is owned 4k, unsorted, unedited`	4K films you own that are not edited and carry no special sorting
`#is watched, !rated`	Films you have watched but not rated
`#is unowned, wishlisted`	Films with releases but none purchased, at least one wishlisted
`#is on hold`	Films temporarily or indefinitely on hold

CHAPTER 5

Number tokens

Year, Duration, and Rating understand comparisons and ranges. Type the number on its own for an exact (or at-least) match, put a symbol with it, or give a range with a hyphen between two numbers.

Year

The film's release year. Years are plain four-digit numbers.

QUERY	FINDS
`#year 1999`	Films released in exactly 1999
`#year 1990–1999`	1990 through 1999, both ends included
`#year >2010`	Released after 2010 (2011 and later)
`#year <1960`	Released before 1960 (1959 and earlier)
`#!year 1990–1999`	Everything except the 1990s, including films with no year recorded

Films with no release year recorded are left out of every range, greater-than, and less-than search.

Duration

Runtime in **whole minutes**. Do not type hours or units; `#duration 2h` means nothing to the search. For a film marked as edited that has an edited runtime, the search uses that edited runtime; every other film uses its regular runtime.

QUERY	FINDS
`#duration 120`	120 minutes **or longer** (a bare number means "at least", not "exactly")
`#duration >150`	Strictly longer than 150 minutes
`#duration <90`	Strictly shorter than 90 minutes
`#duration 90–120`	A range: 90 to 120 minutes, both ends included

Films with no duration recorded are skipped by ranges and by “shorter than” searches.

Rating

Your own rating, from 0 to 10. A rating of **0 means Not Rated**, so the searches below that say “at most” or “less than” never include unrated films by accident.

QUERY	FINDS
`#rating 8`	Rated exactly 8
`#rating 8+`	Rated 8 or higher (at least 8)
`#rating 8-`	Rated 8 or lower, but rated (unrated films are excluded)
`#rating >7`	Rated above 7 (8, 9, 10)
`#rating <5`	Rated below 5 and rated (1 to 4)
`#rating 0`	Films you have not rated
`#rating 7-9`	A range: rated 7, 8, or 9, both ends included

RANGES AND THE HYPHEN

A range needs a whole number on *both* sides of the hyphen: `7-9`. A hyphen with nothing after it keeps its older meaning for ratings (`8-` is “8 or lower”). Ranges are read literally, so `#rating 0-3` includes unrated films, which the “or lower” and “less than” forms deliberately leave out. A range written backwards, such as `9-7`, matches nothing.

TIP

A number that is not a number (`#rating good`) returns no films, so if a numeric search comes back empty, check the value for stray letters.

CHAPTER 6

Date tokens

Last Watched is the date you most recently watched a film. **Date Added** is the date it entered the library. Both accept exactly the same forms.

Relative dates

The words `today`, `week`, `month`, and `year`, on their own or after `last`, `past`, `previous`, or `this`, are rolling windows, so “past week”, “this week”, and “last week” all mean the same thing. Give a number to widen the window: `last 3 months`, `past 10 days`, or just `6 weeks`.

QUERY	FINDS
`#watched today`	Watched since the start of today
`#watched week`	Watched in the past seven days
`#watched past month`	Watched in the past month
`#added year`	Added within the past twelve months

The windows are rolling: “week” is the last seven days counting back from this moment, not the calendar week.

How long ago

Say how long ago, the way you would in conversation. An “ago” search is deliberately loose, because few people remember the exact day: it also takes in a little time on either side of the date it lands on.

QUERY	FINDS
`#watched 2 months ago`	Watched within a week either side of the date two months back
`#watched a year and a half ago`	Within a month either side of eighteen months back
`#watched a couple of weeks ago`	Within three days either side of two weeks back
`#watched a week ago today`	Exactly that day: adding `today` removes the leeway
`#added about 3 days ago`	That day, give or take one day

COUNTED IN	LEEWAY EITHER SIDE
Days	None for one or two days; one day for three or more
Weeks, fortnights	Two days for a single week; three days otherwise
Months	One week
Years	One month
Decades	Six months

Units: `day` `days`, `week` `weeks` `wk` `wks`, `fortnight` `fortnights`, `month` `months` `mo` `mos`, `year` `years` `yr` `yrs`, `decade` `decades`.

Counts: digits, including decimals (`1.5 years ago`), or words: `a`, `an`, `one`, `single`, `a single`; `half`, `half a`, `half an`, `a half`; `two`, `couple`, `a couple`, `pair`, `a pair`; `three`, `few`, `a few`; `four`, `several`; `five`; `six`, `half dozen`, `half a dozen`; `seven`, `eight`, `nine`, `ten`, `eleven`; `twelve`, `dozen`, `a dozen`; `fifteen`, `eighteen`, `twenty`, `thirty`. A unit on its own counts one (`over a year`), and `and a half` after the unit adds half of one.

Older or more recent than

Put a comparison in front of an amount of time to search on one side of it instead of around it. The `ago` is optional here.

QUERY	FINDS
`#watched more than 2 years ago`	Last watched over two years back
`#watched over a year`	The same idea, one year
`#watched less than 3 weeks ago`	Watched in the past three weeks
`#added within 3 weeks`	Added in the past three weeks

MEANING	WORDS
Older than	`more than` `over` `at least` `older than` `longer than`
More recent than	`less than` `under` `fewer than` `newer than` `no more than` `at most` `within`

Named days

VALUE	FINDS
`today` `tonight`	Since the start of today
`yesterday` `last night`	Yesterday
`day before yesterday`	The day before that
`recently` `lately` `recent`	The past 30 days
`friday`, `this friday`	The most recent Friday, today included
`last friday`, `previous friday`	The most recent Friday before today
`weekend`, `this weekend`	The most recent Saturday and Sunday, including one under way
`last weekend`	The most recent weekend that is over
`earlier this week` `earlier this month` `earlier this year`	Since the start of the calendar week, month, or year

Weekdays can be written in full or short: `sunday` `sun`, `monday` `mon`, `tuesday` `tue` `tues`, `wednesday` `wed`, `thursday` `thu` `thur` `thurs`, `friday` `fri`, `saturday` `sat`.

Months, seasons, quarters, and holidays

Name a stretch of the calendar, with or without a year. Without one, it means the most recent occurrence that has begun; `last` means the most recent one that is over; `this` means the one under way, or else this year's.

QUERY	FINDS
`#watched march`	The most recent March
`#watched last december`	The most recent December that has ended
`#watched dec 25`	The most recent December 25; `25 december` works too
`#watched december 25th, 2020`	That day; ordinals such as `1st` and `25th` are fine
`#watched last summer`	June through August of the most recent summer that is over
`#added q3 2024`	July through September 2024
`#watched christmas 2023`	December 24–26, 2023
`#watched 2020-12`	December 2020; `12/2020` works too

KIND	WORDS
Months	`january` `jan`, `february` `feb`, `march` `mar`, `april` `apr`, `may`, `june` `jun`, `july` `jul`, `august` `aug`, `september` `sep` `sept`, `october` `oct`, `november` `nov`, `december` `dec`
Seasons	`spring` (March–May), `summer` (June–August), `fall` (September–November), `winter` (December–February, named for the year its December falls in: `winter 2024` runs into 2025)
Quarters	`q1` `q2` `q3` `q4`
Holidays	`christmas` `xmas` (December 24–26), `christmas eve`, `christmas day`, `new years eve` `nye`, `new years` `new year` `new years day` (December 31–January 1), `halloween`, `valentines` `valentines day`, `independence day` or `fourth of july` (July 4), `thanksgiving` (the fourth Thursday of November through that Sunday), `holidays` `holiday season` (December 20–January 2)

Early, mid, and late

Narrow any year, month, or decade to a part of it. A year divides into January–April, May–August, and September–December; a month into the 1st–10th, 11th–20th, and 21st to the end; halves split at the middle.

QUERY	FINDS
`#watched early december 2020`	December 1–10, 2020
`#watched late 2023`	September through December 2023
`#added first half of 2023`	January through June 2023; `second half` is July through December
`#watched late last year`	The last third of the previous calendar year; `early this year` works the same way

`early`, `beginning`, and `start` mean the first part; `mid` and `middle` the middle; `late` and `end` the last. `first half` and `second half` need a year.

Decades

`2010s` is 2010 through 2019. Two digits work too, with or without an apostrophe: `90s` and `'90s` are the 1990s, `10s` the 2010s. Add early, mid, or late: `early 2000s`.

Spans and open-ended dates

Join any two of the forms in this chapter to search the time between them, both ends included, or lead with one word to search everything on one side.

QUERY	FINDS
`#watched between 2019 and 2021`	January 1, 2019 through December 31, 2021
`#watched march to june 2025`	March through June 2025; a year on the right applies to both sides
`#watched since march`	From the start of the most recent March on
`#watched after last summer`	From the end of last summer on
`#added before 2020`	Before January 1, 2020; `prior to 2020` is the same

Span words: `between` … `and`, or `from` … `to`, `through`, `thru`, `until`, `till`. One-sided: `since` and `from` (from the start of), `after` (from the end of), `before` and `prior to` (before the start of), `until`, `till`, `through`, `thru` (up to the end of). The `>` and `<` operators below accept these phrases too: `#watched >last summer`.

Any date, and this day in history

VALUE	FINDS
`ever` `anytime` `any time` `any date`	Every film with a date recorded
`this day` `this date` (or *on this day*)	Today's month and day in any year

Writing a phrase

Capitals, apostrophes, and commas never matter (`New Year's Eve` is `new years eve`). Filler words are ignored wherever they appear: `about`, `around`, `roughly`, `approximately`, `circa`, `the`, `on`, `in`, `of`, `during`, and `sometime`. So `#watched sometime around 2 months ago` and `#watched in the last 3 months` both work.

Before and after

Put `>` (after) or `<` (before) in front of a year or a full date. Both are exclusive: the date you name is not itself included.

QUERY	FINDS
`#watched >2022`	Watched in 2023 or later (after the end of 2022)
`#watched <2020`	Watched in 2019 or earlier (before the start of 2020)
`#added >2024.06.30`	Added after June 30, 2024
`#added <2021-01-01`	Added before January 1, 2021

A year-range for a date field is built from two tokens: `#watched >2018` with `#watched <2021` finds films watched in 2019 or 2020.

A particular year, month, or day

QUERY	FINDS
`#watched 2025`	Watched at any time in calendar year 2025, from January 1 through December 31
`#watched december 2020`	Watched at any time in December 2020
`#watched dec 2020`	The same, with the abbreviated month
`#watched dec, 2020`	The same; a comma after the month is accepted
`#watched 2020.12.25`	Watched on exactly that day

A full day can be written as `2020.12.25`, `2020-12-25`, or `12/25/2020`.

No date at all

The keyword `none` (or `never`) finds films with no date recorded for the field. For Last Watched that means no viewing date.

QUERY	FINDS
`#watched none`	Films with no viewing date recorded
`#!watched none`	Films with a viewing date

> **A DATE IS NOT THE SAME AS "WATCHED"**
> Last Watched searches the *viewing date*. A film you marked as watched without a date (common for viewings that predate the dates you started recording) is found by `#watched none`, because it has no date. The watched flag itself has no search token yet; the Filter menu offers it.

When a date is not understood

A value that is not in any of the forms above, or that names a date that does not exist (`#watched >2020.13.45`, `#watched soonish`), finds **nothing**, exactly as a misspelled title does. Negated, it finds every film (`#!watched soonish`), because a NOT returns whatever the plain search did not.

CHAPTER 7

The Release token

A film can have several releases (a 4K disc, a Blu-ray, a DVD, a wishlist entry). `#release` asks whether a film has at least one release with a given property. The value is a keyword from the list below; capitalization does not matter.

HOW TO READ THE RESULTS

A film matches if *any* of its releases has the property. Two Release tokens are checked independently, so `#release 4k` with `#release purchased` finds films that have a 4K release and have a purchased release, which may be two different discs. For "a purchased 4K disc" use the smart list instead: `#list purchased 4k`.

Ownership

TYPE ANY OF	MATCHES FILMS WITH…
`purchased` `owned`	a release you have purchased
`unpurchased` `wishlist` `wanted`	a release you have not purchased (a wishlist release)

Release date

A release's own date, which can be up to a year ahead. These forms are read as dates only when the whole value is one of them, so a distributor's name is never mistaken for a date.

TYPE	MATCHES FILMS WITH…
`upcoming` `unreleased` `preorder` `pre-order`	a release whose date is still ahead, purchased or not (the same films as the Upcoming Releases smart list)
`2027`	a release dated in that year
`2020-2027`	a release dated in that span of years, both ends included
`>2026` `<2020`	a release dated after or before that year
`>2026.10.01` `<2020-06-15`	a release dated after or before that day (the day itself excluded)
`March 2027` `Mar 2027`	a release dated in that month

`2027.03.14`	a release dated that day

A release recorded with only its year matches the year forms, and a day form only when the whole year lies on one side of the day: a release known only as “2026” is neither before nor after `2026.06.01`. The relative and natural phrases of the date tokens (`past week`, `last summer`) are not accepted here; they look back from today, and a release date can lie ahead.

Format

TYPE ANY OF	MATCHES FILMS WITH…
`4k` `uhd`	a 4K UHD release
`bluray` `blu-ray` `2k`	a Blu-ray release
`dvd`	a DVD release

Write `bluray` or `blu-ray` as one word; `blu ray` with a space is not recognized.

4K master

TYPE EXACTLY	MATCHES FILMS WITH…
`native 4k` `native`	a 4K release mastered from a true 4K source
`upscaled` `upscale`	a 4K release upscaled from a 2K master

These two must be typed as the whole value. `native 4k` is read as a master type, not as the 4K format.

HDR

TYPE EXACTLY	MATCHES FILMS WITH…
`hdr`	a release in any HDR format (Dolby Vision, HDR10, or HDR10+)
`dolby vision` `dv`	a Dolby Vision release
`hdr10`	an HDR10 *or* HDR10+ release (HDR10+ discs play back as HDR10)
`hdr10+` `hdrplus` `hdr+`	an HDR10+ release only

Region

Periods are ignored, so `reg. a` works like `reg a`.

TYPE ANY OF	MATCHES FILMS WITH…
`region a` `reg a` `rega`	a Region A release
`region b` `reg b` `regb`	a Region B release, including loosely locked B
`region free` `reg free` `no region` `no reg` `no lock` `unlocked`	a region-free release
`region 1` to `region 5` `reg 1` to `reg 5`, `reg1` to `reg5`	a DVD of that numbered region

Origin, remaster, and packaging

TYPE ANY OF	MATCHES FILMS WITH…
`imported` `foreign`	a release whose national origin is something other than domestic (releases with no origin set are neither)
`remastered` `remaster` `rem`	a remastered release
`combo-pack` `combopack` `combo`	a combo-pack release (both the single-Blu-ray and dual-Blu-ray forms)
`standalone`	a standalone release
`multi-pack` `multipack` `multi`	a multi-pack release

Anything else: distributor or studio

If the value is none of the keywords above, it is matched against the **studio or distributor of each release**, as text. `#release criterion` finds films with a Criterion release; `#release shout` finds Shout! Factory releases. This is the disc's own studio, which is separate from the film's studio searched by `#studio`.

KEYWORDS WIN OVER STUDIOS

Because keywords and dates are checked first, a distributor whose name is also a keyword (or contains one, such as one containing “4k”) will be read as the keyword. Include more of the name to steer around that.

CHAPTER 8

The Rotation Threshold token

The rotation threshold is how long a film rests before it comes up for rotation again. Each film either follows the global default (set in Settings > General) or carries its own override. The token can search by the threshold value or by whether an override exists.

Searching by value

Available thresholds are 12, 18, 24, 36, 48, and 60 months (1, 1½, 2, 3, 4, and 5 years). Write the value as months or years, with or without a unit.

QUERY	READS AS
`#rotation 24`	24 months. A bare number is tried as months first.
`#rotation 2`	Not a valid month count, so read as 2 years = 24 months
`#rotation 2 years`	24 months. Also accepted: `2 year`, `2 yr`, `2 yr.`
`#rotation 24 months`	24 months. Also accepted: `24 month`, `24 mo`, `24 mo.`
`#rotation 1.5`	1½ years = 18 months

A value search matches a film's **effective** threshold. That is the film's override if it has one, otherwise the current global default. So if the default is 2 years, `#rotation 2 years` finds *both* films explicitly set to 2 years *and* films that simply follow the default.

Values the app cannot map to a real threshold return no films: `6 months`, `7`, `36 years`, and `2 dingus` all return nothing. A unit must be a real one, and a month value must be an exact whole number.

Searching by override

Three keywords test whether a film has its own threshold set, regardless of what number it is.

QUERY	FINDS
`#rotation default`	Films set to **Default**, with no override of their own
`#rotation override`	Films with an override of any value
`#rotation custom`	The same as `override`
`#!rotation default`	The same as `override`: everything not following the default

DEFAULT MEANS "SET TO DEFAULT"

With a 2-year default, a film whose threshold has been explicitly changed to 2 years has an override (it just happens to match the default today). It does **not** appear under `#rotation default`, and it **does** appear under `#rotation override`, `#rotation custom`, and `#rotation 2 years`. If you later change the global default, that film keeps its 2 years, while films set to Default follow the new value.

Putting them together

QUERY	FINDS
`#rotation override` `#!rotation 5 years`	Films with an override that is not 5 years
`#rotation override` `#rotation 12`	Films explicitly set to 12 months
`#rotation default` `#list up for rotation`	Films currently up for rotation that follow the default

CHAPTER 9

Recipes

Each recipe lists one token per line. Type each one separately, pressing Return after each, so that every line becomes its own pill.

Everything one director made in a decade

```
#director scorsese
#year 1970–1979
```

Scorsese films from the 1970s

Highly rated and long

```
#rating 8+
#duration >150
```

Films rated 8 or higher that run longer than two and a half hours

Everything an actor was in, minus a genre

```
#cast nicolas cage
#!genre comedy
```

Cage films that are not comedies

Two actors together

```
#cast al pacino
#cast robert de niro
```

Films that list both

Either of two filmmakers

```
#/director kubrick
#/director lynch
```

Every Kubrick film and every Lynch film

Owned in 4K, untouched, not seen in a year

```
#is owned 4k, unsorted, unedited
#watched over 1 year ago
```

4K films you own with no edit and no special sorting, last watched more than a year ago. Use `#!watched within 1 year` instead to include films never watched.

No viewing date recorded

```
#watched none
```

Films with no viewing date

No viewing date, and added a while ago

`#watched none` `#added <2024`	No viewing date, added before 2024

Everything I watched in one year

`#watched 2025`	Viewed at any time in 2025

What I watched last month and loved

`#watched month` `#rating 9+`	Viewed in the past month, rated 9 or 10

Things I want to buy on 4K

`#list unpurchased 4k`	The Unpurchased 4K smart list, as a search

Dolby Vision discs that I own

`#release dolby vision` `#release purchased`	Films with a Dolby Vision release and a purchased release (these may be different discs; see the note in Chapter 7)

Region-free imports

`#release imported` `#release region free`	Films with an imported release and a region-free release

Native 4K releases from one label

`#release native 4k` `#release criterion`	Films with a native 4K release and a Criterion release

Combo packs I should look at again

`#release combo` `#!release standalone`	Films that have a combo pack but no standalone release

Films with my own rotation schedule

`#rotation override`	Every film with a custom threshold

Films with a long rest period

`#rotation 5 years`	Films whose effective threshold is five years (override or default)

A title fragment, narrowed by token

`star` `#year <1990`	Type `star` as plain text, then add the Year token: films with “star” in the title released before 1990

Everything except one kind of film

`#!genre documentary`	The whole library minus documentaries

A person in any role

`#crew clint eastwood`	Films where he directed, acted, produced, wrote, or scored

Find something you only vaguely remember

`#synopsis heist vault`
`#year 2000–2009`
`#!genre animation`
	The summary mentions a heist and a vault, released in the 2000s, not animated

A mid-range runtime from films I rated well

`#duration 90–120` `#rating 7–9`	Between 90 and 120 minutes, rated 7 to 9

CHAPTER 10

Troubleshooting

Almost every surprising result comes from one of the situations below.

WHAT YOU SEE	WHAT IS GOING ON
Results do not change after I type `#director kubrick`	Press **Return**. Until you do, the search is paused and the results show what the previous tokens found. The token also needs a value after the field name and a space.
The “Enter Search Token” message appears	You started a token (typed `#`) but have not confirmed one yet. Finish it with a value and Return, or delete the `#` text.
I pressed Return and nothing happened	The text after `#` is not a field name. Check the spelling against Chapter 3 or choose from the suggestion list.
A number search returns nothing	Number tokens take digits and the symbols `>` `<` `+` `–` only. Letters, units, and words make the search match nothing.
A date search returns nothing	The date was not understood (a misspelled word, a day or month that does not exist, a symbol in the wrong place). Chapter 6 lists every form that is.
A NOT search returns the whole library	The value was not understood, so the matching version found nothing, and the opposite of nothing is everything. Check the value.
Rating “8-” or “<5” does not show unrated films	By design: 0 means Not Rated, and “at most” or “less than” searches leave those out. Use `#rating 0` to find them.
`#list purchased` also shows unpurchased films	“Unpurchased” contains the word “purchased”. Add `#!list unpurchased`.
My OR token brought in films I did not expect	OR tokens are not limited by AND tokens. See the warning in Chapter 2.
`#release` value finds nothing	It may match no keyword and fall through to a distributor name. Check Chapter 7 for the exact spelling, including `bluray` without a space.
A smart list name finds nothing	Smart lists must be enabled in Settings for `#list` to see them. Film Queue lists are never searchable.
A rotation value finds nothing	Only 12, 18, 24, 36, 48, and 60 months (1, 1.5, 2, 3, 4, 5 years) exist. Anything else, including a number with an unknown unit,

	matches nothing.
A film appears that does not seem to match	Matching is by letters, anywhere in the text, so a short value matches inside longer words. Lengthen the value.

CHAPTER 11

Cheat sheet

The whole language on one page.

Making a token

`#` field, space, value, **Return**. `⌘F` focuses the search field.

Prefixes (after the #)

`#`	AND: must match
`#/`	OR: add matches
`#!`	NOT: remove matches
`#/!`	NOT (OR is ignored)

Text fields (match anywhere, any case)

`title` `cast` `director` `producer` `exp` `writer` `composer` `crew` `genre` `studio` `tags` `notes` `list`

Is: `is` (comma-separated, `!` negates a term)

`owned 4k, unsorted, !edited` · `watched` `rated` `complete` `sorted` `on hold` `owned` `unowned` `no releases` `wishlisted` `upcoming` `alternate versions` `hall of fame`

Synopsis: `synopsis` `plot` `description`

Every word must appear, in any order: `detective sins mills`

Number fields (ranges include both ends)

`year`	`1999` `1990–1999` `>2010` `<1960`
`duration`	minutes (edited runtime if any): `120` (at least) `90–120` `>150` `<90`
`rating`	`8` `7–9` `8+` `8–` `>7` `<5` `0` = unrated

Order of operations

AND tokens → add OR matches → remove NOT matches → narrow by typed title text.

Date fields: `watched` and `added`

`today` `week` `month` `year`	rolling windows
`2 months ago`	around then
`more than 2 years ago`	older / newer than
`last summer` `dec 25`	a named period
`since march` `2019 to 2021`	open-ended / spans
`>2022` `<2020`	after / before a year
`>2024.06.30`	after / before a day
`dec 2020`	a month
`2025`	a calendar year
`2020.12.25`	a day
`none` `never`	no date recorded

Anything else finds nothing.

Release

`purchased` `owned` `unpurchased` `wishlist` `wanted` · `4k` `uhd` `bluray` `dvd` · `native 4k` `upscaled` · `hdr` `dolby vision` `hdr10` `hdr10+` · `region a` `region b` `region free` `region 1`–`5` · `imported` `remastered` · `combo` `standalone` `multi` · anything else = distributor name

Rotation Threshold

`24` `2` `2 years` `24 months`	effective value (override or default)
`default`	set to Default (no override)
`override` `custom`	has an override

Values: 12, 18, 24, 36, 48, 60 months

Two-word names to avoid

`#date added` reads as Year and `#rotation threshold` matches nothing. Type `#added` and `#rotation`.